

Explanation-guided successes

Matched test images and generated answer excerpts; blue text marks the guided student.



Local texture and shape

Saliency preserves small discriminative surface details.

Observed preference: Explanation-guided variants are student-preferred; global MSE is teacher-preferred.

Student, global MSE

"The image shows a close-up of a mushroom with a distinctive appearance. The cap of the mushroom is light brown and has a slightly textured surface, with some areas appearing more raised or bumpy than others ..."

Reading The saliency-guided answer keeps the cap's raised texture and reddish surface, while the global-MSE student drifts toward a generic mushroom description.

Student, explanation-guided

"The image shows a close-up of a mushroom with a reddish-brown cap. The cap has a rough, textured surface with small, raised spots and ridges. The edges of the cap appear to be slightly curled inward. The ..."



Object identity recovery

The guided student recovers the visible object identity.

Observed preference: All explanation-guided variants are student-preferred; global MSE hallucinates another object.

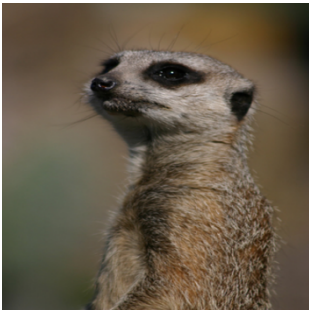
Student, global MSE

"The image shows a pair of red high-heeled shoes with white trim and a pointed toe. The shoes are placed on a wooden surface, and there is a patterned wallpaper in the background featuring a mix of geometric shapes ..."

Reading The explanation-guided output describes bowls and colors, whereas the MSE student produces an unrelated shoe description.

Student, explanation-guided

"The image shows three bowls placed on a surface. The bowls are of different colors: one is red, another is brown, and the third is a combination of both colors. They appear to be ceramic or porcelain, with smooth ..."



Part and pose fidelity

The guided student preserves a part-level pose cue.

Observed preference: Explanation-guided variants are student-preferred; the global-MSE student fails to use the image.

Student, global MSE

"I'm sorry, but I cannot see any image attached to your message. Please provide more information or rephrase your request so that I can assist you better."

Reading The saliency-guided answer keeps the upright posture and front-paw cue, showing that small part relations can survive the visual swap.

Student, explanation-guided

"The image shows a meerkat standing upright on its hind legs, with its front paws resting on its chest. The meerkat has a light brown fur coat and is looking slightly to the side. The background is blurred ..."